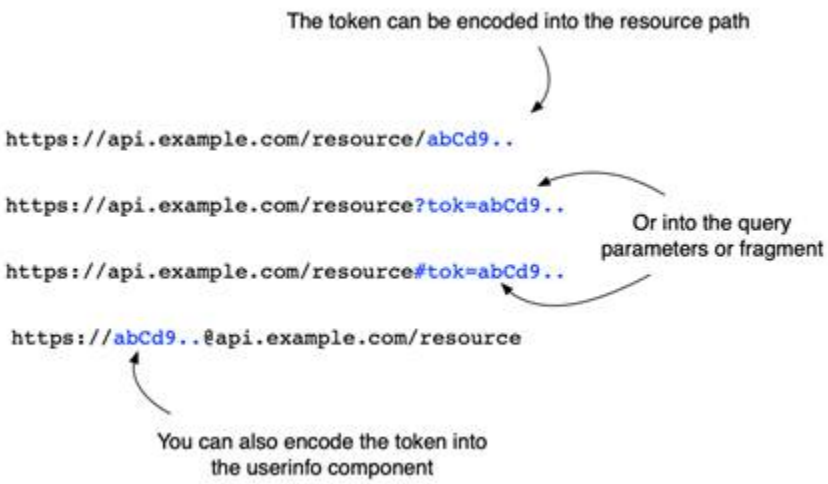


Figure 9.2 There are many ways to encode a security token into a URI. You can encode it into the resource path, or you can provide it using a query parameter. More sophisticated representations encode the token into the fragment or userinfo elements of the URI, but these require some client-side parsing.

A commonly used approach is to encode a random token into the path component of the URI, which is what the Dropbox Chooser API does, returning URIs like the following:

```
https://dl.dropboxusercontent.com/1/view/8ygmwuqzf1l6x7c/
[CA]book/graphics/CH08_FIG8.2_RBAC.png
```

In the Dropbox case the random token is encoded into a prefix of the actual file path. Although this is a natural representation, it means that the same resource may be represented by URIs with completely different paths depending on the token, so a client that receives access to the same resource through different capability URIs may not